

2.2.1 Buddhism

Good and evil

Good and evil	• Concepts of good and evil • Skilful and unskilful actions • The role of Mara
Buddhist beliefs about the causes of evil	• Concepts of natural and moral evil • Approaches to why there is evil and suffering in the world • Responses to the problem • Kamma and rebirth
Coping with suffering	• Understanding ways of coping with suffering through: - Kamma - Meditation - Detachment - The three refuges
Sources and reasons for moral behaviour	• The scriptures • The three refuges • The example of Buddha • The eightfold path

Religion, reason and revelation

Form and nature of revelation

- Concept of revelation
- Revelation of ultimate truths through Buddhas and bodhisattvas
- How nibbana might be known:
 - Scriptures
 - Meditation
 - Buddhas
 - Bodhisattvas

Authority and importance of sacred texts

- The origins of the Buddhist scriptures
- Significance and importance of the Buddhist scriptures

Religion and science

Origins of the world and life

- Scientific theories about the origins of the world and humanity
- Why Buddhists may not accept scientific theories
- The relationship between scientific and religious understandings of the origins of the world and humanity
- The cyclical nature of the universe
- The refusal to answer questions on causation
- The cycle of dependent origination

People and animals

- The place of humanity in relation to animals
- Attitudes to animals and their treatment

Environmental issues

- Responses to environmental issues
- Religious teachings relating to environmental issues